

Zero-Trust Operating Rules & Sensory Immutability Canon

Subsystem: `aesop-xi/policies/`

Governing Authority: Chief Ethical Orchestration Protocol (Æsop-Xi)

Target Audience: All Autonomous Edge Agents, Verification Daemons, and Planning Nodes

1. Principle of Sensory Immutability (Tier 1 Canon)

1. **Absolute Write Prohibition:** Raw intake folders (`01_raw_sources/`, `raw/`, and incoming sensory assets) are immutable cold archives. Under no circumstances may any agent write, delete, move, or modify any file within these paths.
 2. **Read-Only Derived Workflows:** All processing of raw sources must operate by reading the source and emitting new derivative files into `clean_md/`, `chunks/`, or `wiki_md/`.
 3. **Cryptographic Ground Truth:** Every file ingested into `raw/` receives an immediate SHA-256 hash stamped in `manifest.jsonl`. If a file's hash changes in place, the integrity monitor halts processing immediately.
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2. Sandboxed Verification ("Nothing Self-Certifies")

1. **Independent Verification:** No script, cleaner, or transformation pipeline may certify its own output.
 2. **Separation of Extraction and Audit:** The agent that extracts text or generates candidate scripts is strictly barred from issuing the approval signature.
 3. **Fail-Closed Default:** If an audit script, verifier, or syntax checker crashes or encounters an unknown condition, the candidate batch is marked `FAIL` and quarantined.
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3. The Incognito Red Gatekeeper Isolation Contract

1. **Sealed Sandbox:** The Red Auditor lives inside `.incognito_red_sandbox/` (or `/opt/red-agent/`). It runs headlessly and asynchronously.
2. **Zero Discovery Invariant:** The Red Auditor must not be registered in public user-facing manifests or exposed in general agent system prompts.

3. **Narrow Contract:** Worker agents drop candidate batches into `incoming/`. The Red Daemon evaluates the batch against strict guardrails and moves it to either `approved/` (+1.0) or `quarantined/` (-1.0).
 4. **No Direct Inter-Agent Negotiation:** The Red Auditor does not debate, chat, or negotiate. It outputs a deterministic verdict and error trace.
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4. Execution Clearance & Tool Gating

1. **Pre-Flight Clearance:** Before invoking any shell command, executing Python scripts, or writing files, the worker agent must obtain a signed `ClearanceToken` from `arbitration_engine.py`.
2. **Thermal & RAM Headroom Check:** If `hardware_throttler.py` detects thermal state `CRITICAL` (>48°C) or RAM <1024MB, background tasks must yield immediately to preserve system responsiveness and prevent Android LMK eviction.
3. **Audit Ledger Logging:** Every granted clearance, task rejection, and thermal throttling event must be written to the local audit ledger.